

RAPID ACQUISITION CSO CALL 002

FA700025SC001

U.S. Air Force Academy

Amendment 1

Focused Interest Period - USAFA-002, ACADEMICS – 002 USAFA Military Exoskeleton Technology

- 1.1. This is **Call 002** placed against the United States Air Force Academy (USAFA) Rapid Acquisition Commercial Solutions Opening (CSO) FA700025SC001. The Area of Interest (AoI) is **USAFA-002, Academics**. The CSO is a closed CSO with calls. Calls for proposals will be issued by the Government as amendments to this CSO and may be made at any time during its open period when support for innovative commercial requirements supporting USAFA priorities are identified. Please refer to the body of the CSO for further information and a complete overview of the function and process of the CSO. Offerors may submit proposals only in response to a specified area of interest issued during an open call for proposals. The focused area of interest described in this call will be open for submission until **15 Sep 2025 at 12:00 PM MDT**.
- 1.2. USAFA has a focused interest in exploring how **passive** and artificial intelligence (AI)-enabled exoskeleton technology can enhance warfighter lethality. While these technologies promise to improve warfighter endurance, situational awareness, and mission effectiveness, significant gaps exist in the understanding of key human factors. More insight is needed into optimal interface design, cognitive workload management, and team integration protocols to ensure safe, efficient, and resilient operations. USAFA is seeking vendors capable of providing lightweight, wearable, full and lower extremity exoskeletons **in a variety of sizes and configurations (powered or passive)** that provide strength and endurance assistance, have their own power source, use an intuitive software program that adapts to the motor movements of the current user to provide customizable assistance and can be calibrated for various users.
 - 1.2.1. The full and lower body exoskeletons shall:
 - allow the user to initiate movement but does not independently perform motor functions.
 - provide user-initiated movement via **unpowered or** powered function--including via pneumatic or similar mechanisms.
 - allow user flexible movement such as squatting, bending down, marching, jogging, lifting weights, etc.
 - be able to calibrate/programable to multiple users of various height and weight ranges.
 - not require medical assistance to put on/take off.
 - be suitable for individual function without medical supervision.
 - 1.2.2. Essential physical characteristics shall include:
 - freestanding and not linked to other equipment such as a treadmill or stationary power source.
 - if required, battery powered connectivity (at least 4 hours) that has the power supply attached around the hip, waist, back, or the leg portions of the device.
 - adjustable hip buckle to accommodate a range of widths (20-42 inches).
 - can accommodate a user's weight range of up to at least 275 lbs.
- 1.3. Any questions regarding this focused area of interest or utilizing this CSO may be directed to the POC at 10CONS.PKB.CSO@us.af.mil and tammy.martin.6@us.af.mil. (Refer to paragraph 1.4.2. below for Phase 1 submission instructions):

Attn: Tammy Martin, Contracting Officer

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1.4. Submission guidelines:

- 1.4.1. This call will be conducted in two or three phases as described in the body of the CSO. The Government reserves the right to forgo Phase II and go directly to Phase III based on technically competent Phase I submissions. Submission instructions for this call will follow the submission guidelines outlined in Part 5 of the body of the CSO.
- 1.4.2. Interested offerors must submit Quad Charts and Solution Briefs prepared in accordance with the formats in Attachments 1 and 2 respectively in the body of the CSO. Phase I submissions will be evaluated against criteria as described in Attachment 7 of the CSO.
 - 1.4.2.1. All Quad Charts shall include the information indicated on the sample template in Attachment 1.
 - 1.4.2.2. The Solution Brief narrative expands on the Quad Chart presentation. Instructions for format and content are located in Attachment 2.
 - 1.4.2.3. Only documentation required for Phase 1 submissions are being accepted at this time. Proposals or other documentation will not be accepted.
- 1.4.3. As described in Attachment 7 of the CSO, the Government will determine the most technically competent and capable of the qualified Phase I offerors using the criteria below:
 - 1.4.3.1. Technical merit / applicability,
 - 1.4.3.2. Importance to agency programs; and
 - 1.4.3.3. Funds availability.
- 1.4.4. Solution Briefs and quad chart submissions shall be sent to **10CONS.PKB.CSO@us.af.mil** and **tammy.martin.6@us.af.mil** for review by **15 Sep 2025 at 12:00 PM MDT**. All solution briefs must be unclassified. The Government will not pay companies for the costs associated with solution brief submissions.
- 1.4.5. All offerors providing Phase I submissions will be contacted by the Government, either with an email informing them that the effort proposed is not of interest to the Government at this time or with a request for either a pitch session OR request for proposal by a specific date.
- 1.4.6. The Government reserves the right to fund all, some, one, or none of the proposals submitted or may elect to fund only part of a submission under this CSO.